REFLECTION JOURNAL

A Guide to Professional Growth & Clarity

Your Reflection Journal

The five workbooks in this series gave you frameworks, vocabulary, exercises, and stories. This journal is where you put your answers down in writing.

There is a consistent finding across adult learning research: people who write down what they are going to do are significantly more likely to do it than people who only think about it. This journal exists for that reason. It is not graded. Nobody else needs to read it. It is a record you are keeping for yourself.

Work through each section in order, or skip to the workbook that is most relevant to where you are right now. Date your entries. Come back to them. Notice what changes.

Name _____

Started _____

Target role _____

Target industry _____

> *"Writing is thinking on paper." The act of putting something into words forces you to decide whether you actually believe it.*

From Workbook 1. These questions are about understanding how organizations work and where you fit inside them.

The Organism Map

Think of an organization you have been part of. What was its core source of resources — revenue, grants, tuition, donations?

Who were the people responsible for bringing those resources in? What did their role actually look like day to day?

What was the biggest threat that organization faced? How did it respond?

The C-Suite Map

Name a company you are targeting. Identify the CEO, CFO, COO, and head of Revenue or Sales. What is the CEO's current stated strategic priority?

If you were hired there, which C-suite leader would you ultimately support? Write one sentence connecting your expertise to their priorities.

Culture and Control

What is your Circle of Control right now? List three things fully within your control that you have not been treating as such.

What did your last or current workplace get right about culture? What would have made it better?

Business Foundation Reflections

What was your mental model of "business" before Workbook 1? What changed?

Which organizational level do you understand least — executive, middle management, or individual contributor? What is one concrete step to close that gap?

Write your one-sentence business translation of your core skill: "I can [skill], which means a company can [business outcome]."

02 The Sales Dimension

From Workbook 2. These questions are about understanding how value moves between people and organizations.

Where You Have Already Sold

Where in your past have you sold something — an idea, a proposal, a project, a collaboration — without calling it sales? Describe it: what was the problem, who was the buyer, how did you make the case, and what was the outcome?

Hunter, Farmer, or Expert?

Which role fits you most naturally and why? What evidence from your own history points to that answer?

If you were in a client meeting tomorrow, what specific value could you offer?

Relationships and Reciprocity

Name a professional relationship you have let go cold. What could you offer them — a connection, a piece of useful information, a word of recognition — before asking for anything?

List three professional relationships you will re-engage this month, and what you will offer each one first.

The Deal You Need to Close

If you had to close one deal in the next 90 days — getting someone to say yes to something that matters to your career — what would it be? Who is the buyer? What do you need to understand about their situation before you make the ask?

Your Professional Pitch

Write your two-sentence professional pitch: what you do, for whom, and what changes because of it. Then practice it until you can deliver it without notes.

From Workbook 3. These questions are about quantifying what you deliver and making your contributions legible to others.

Quantifying Your Work

Think of the last significant thing you delivered. Who received it? What did they use it for? Estimate, in hours or dollars, the value it produced for them.

Work through the value calculation for one piece of work:
Time saved per occurrence _____ hours × frequency _____ × hourly rate $_____ = annual value $_____

Resume Translation

Pick two items from your academic or professional background. Translate each into: "I built [X], which saved / produced / enabled [measurable outcome] for [audience]."

Your Most Productive Period

Think about your most productive stretch in the last five years. What made it productive? Were you working alone or collaboratively? What were your goals, and how clear were they? What conditions can you recreate intentionally?

Follow-Through

When did you last follow up on something you sent that did not get a response? If the honest answer is "rarely," what habit change would make follow-up automatic for you?

04 The Product Dimension

From Workbook 4. These questions are about reframing your work as a product and understanding the people who use it.

Reframe a Deliverable as a Product

Pick a deliverable you have produced — a report, an analysis, a program, a project. Who was the user? What job were they trying to do when they reached for your work? Write: "The product is [X]. The user is [Y]. The value delivered is [Z]."

What was the minimum version of that deliverable that would have produced the core value? What could you have cut?

The Design Thinking Interview

Name one person you could have a 20-minute conversation with who represents a user or customer in your target field. What three questions would you ask them about what they actually do — not what they wish existed?

After that conversation (or one you have already had): what three things did you learn that surprised you?

The Gap Between Design and Experience

Think of a process, program, or deliverable you designed or contributed to that was supposed to serve someone else. Where did your design assumptions diverge from what the user actually experienced? What would reducing that friction have looked like?

From Workbook 5. These questions are about understanding yourself — your vision, your leverage, your blind spots, and your purpose.

Vision

When you imagine your career in five years, what does a typical Tuesday look like? Not the title — the actual day. Who are you working with? What kinds of problems are you solving?

Write your five-year career goal in one specific sentence. Then write your ten-year life goal in one more.

What one decision in the next 90 days would move the needle toward those goals?

Leverage Inventory

List five specific things you have done — in school, work, research, service, or life — that a business would pay for. State each as: "I did [X], which produced [Y result]."

What do you know or have experienced that is genuinely hard to come by? Which industries or roles are underserved by that knowledge?

Beliefs Worth Examining

What did you grow up believing about money and ambition? Where did those beliefs come from? Where might they be getting in the way?

Pick one reframe from Workbook 5 that you felt resistance to. Write: "I used to believe _____. Now I am practicing _____." Then name one situation in the next 30 days where you can test the new perspective.

Dark Side Readiness

What is your honest answer to "What is your greatest weakness?" Write it here as you would say it in an interview — acknowledging the real friction point, and describing what you are doing about it.

For each company you are seriously considering: what do you wish you knew about the culture before committing? Who could tell you? Write one specific question you would ask someone who works or has worked there.

Purpose Statement

Fill in the three circles: what you are uniquely trained to do, what you are genuinely drawn to, and what businesses will pay for. Where all three overlap is your purpose zone. Write what you find there.

Complete this sentence: "My work is in service of _____." Then draft your LinkedIn headline — not your job title, but a statement of what you do and for whom.

Write your resume summary in two to three sentences using your intersection map and purpose statement above.

06 Commitments and Milestones

The exercises in this series are only useful if they connect to action. This section is where you set deadlines and hold yourself to them. Fill in each target date. Then keep the date.

Career Materials

Resume

First complete draft finished by _____

Reviewed by one person in my target field by _____

Final version polished by _____

One thing I will change on my resume based on what I learned in this series:

LinkedIn Profile

Headline updated by _____

About section written by _____

Profile complete and active by _____

Elevator Pitch

Write your 60-second verbal introduction here:

Practiced aloud 10 times by _____

Delivered to a real person by _____

Conversations and Network

Informational Interviews

Name five people working in or adjacent to your target field. Commit to reaching out to each one. A 20-minute conversation is the goal — not a job request, but a genuine curiosity about their work.

Contact 1 _____

Reach out by _____

Contact 2 _____

Reach out by _____

Contact 3 _____

Reach out by _____

Contact 4 _____

Reach out by _____

Contact 5 _____

Reach out by _____

One Offer Before One Ask

For each conversation above, write one thing you can offer before you ask for anything. A piece of information, a connection, a word of recognition they have not received.

Job Search

Applications

First application submitted by _____

5 applications submitted by _____

First interview scheduled by _____

Offer received by _____

Interview Preparation

List five behavioral interview stories you will prepare. State each as: "I did [X] when [situation], and the result was [Y]."

All five stories practiced aloud by _____

Mock interview completed by _____

First 90 Days on the Job

If you are already in your target role, or when you land there

Three people I will build relationships with outside my immediate team in the first month:

Two things I will observe about how information flows in this organization:

The question I will ask my manager at the 30-day mark about how success is actually measured in this role:

30-day check-in with manager by _____

60-day check-in with manager by _____

90-day check-in with manager by _____

Open Pages

Use these pages for anything the structured prompts did not capture — additional notes, names, ideas, questions you want to sit with longer, or things you want to revisit when you come back to this journal.